

Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick

Twenty-Sixth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 27th September 2026

Parish Clergy: Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

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Thoughts on the Gospel (*Matthew 21:28-32*)

Life is full of promises – to change, improve, forgive, serve, and do what is right. Yet even sincere intentions can remain only words.

Jesus tells of two sons asked to work in their father's vineyard. One refused but later went; the other agreed but did not. The story shows that actions matter more than words.

True change turns faith into action: the gospel passage invites us to be honest about where we need to grow, to live out kindness and forgiveness, to refuse to be defined by past mistakes, to offer God a willing heart, to examine our conduct, and embrace every opportunity to do good. God values sincere action over empty promises, and it is never too late to begin again.

Lord, fill our hearts with Your love and guide us to live our faith each day. Amen.

St Patrick's Church, Murlog – Vigil Mass Please note that the Vigil Mass at St Patrick's Church, Murlog will be celebrated at 6.00 pm from next Saturday (3rd October) onwards. Thank you all for your cooperation and understanding.

First Communion & Confirmation Mass of Enrolment As part of our 'Do this in Memory of Me' programme, a Mass of Enrolment will take place for children preparing for **First Holy Communion** and **First Penance**, AND for those children in **Confirmation** Preparation: All those preparing for **First Holy Communion** and **Confirmation** and their families are invited to these Masses.

Saturday 3rd October at 4.30 pm in Church of Immaculate Conception for pupils of St Mary's PS, Cloughcor and Strabane Controlled PS

Saturday 3rd October at 6.00 pm in St Patrick's Church Murlog for pupils of Scoil Naomh Padraig, Scoil Mhuire gan Smal and Scoil Naomh Colmcille

Sunday 4th October at 11.00 am in Church of Immaculate Conception for pupils of St Catherine's PS.

Anniversaries Rose Ashpool, John Buchanan, Margaret Buchanan, Jim Conwell, Alex French, Arthur Friel, Mary Catherine Friel, Eddie Harkin, Brendan Kelly, Paula Keys, Mary Kielty, Kathleen Kirk, Christopher Lawrence, Jimmy Lawrence, Joe McAuley, Donal McCauley, Lily McDermott, Tommy McDermott, Fr William McGaughey, Francie McGinley, Pauline McGinley, Joe McLaughlin, Brendan McManus, Kathleen Melaugh, Ivor Moore, Eva Mullen, Elizabeth White, Campbell Caldwell, Sarah Gallagher, Bridget Sweeney. – May they rest in peace.

9.45 am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections

Leckpatrick £1,211.68, £588.75 (priests' retirement)

Clonleigh €1,782.23, €288.20 (priests' retirement)

Camus £1,626.11, £649.95 (priests' retirement)

Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 4th October:

1st Reading: Isaiah 5:1–7

Psalms: 80:9, 12–16, 19–20

2nd Reading: Philippians 4:6–9

Gospel: Matthew 21:33–43

Saints of the Coming Week:

Monday: St Lawrence Ruiz & companions, martyrs, St Wenceslaus, martyr

Tuesday: St Michael, St Gabriel & St Raphael, Archangels

Wednesday: St Jerome, priest and doctor of the Church

Thursday: St Therese of the Child Jesus, virgin & doctor of the Church

Friday: The Holy Guardian Angels

Annual Safeguarding Mass Bishop Router invites everyone involved in safeguarding to the Annual Safeguarding Mass on Friday 2nd October at 7.30 pm in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry. The Safeguarding Mass will be offered for peace, reconciliation and healing for all who have suffered the pain of abuse. The Mass will also be offered in thanksgiving for the Parish Safeguarding Representatives in parishes across the diocese, and diocesan staff/volunteers who continue to work and support ongoing safeguarding practices across our diocese.

Legion of Mary An urgent appeal for new members to join us. Role includes visitation of nursing homes, promotion of the rosary with the pilgrim statue and weekly meetings. Time commitment of approx 3 hrs per wk. Meeting on Thursday mornings at 11 am in St Pat's Hall. Please contact Margaret Harte: 028 71883159.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8.00 pm in the Pastoral Office, 27 Butcher Street, Strabane. Everyone welcome.

Thornhill Ministries will lead an introduction to the practice of praying scripture in a reflective way that will help participants let the Word of God nestle in the quiet corner of the heart. 'Open heart – Open to the Word' series of 4 Sundays in October from 3:30 – 4:30 pm in Emmaus Room, Pennyburn Church, Derry.

Monthly Men's Rosary will take place on Saturday 3rd October at 1.00 pm at Market Square, Letterkenny. New attendees welcome.

A St Faustina Weekend takes place in St Mary's, Convoy, F93FX66 on 3rd/4th October, with prayer and reflection on Divine Mercy Devotions. Led by Fr Eamonn Kelly, the weekend invites all to come to know the Person of Divine Mercy. You are invited to come to all or part of the weekend.

ACCORD Marriage Preparation Course The next course is on 20th/21st November at Ebrington Hotel, Derry. Limited places. Booking: www.accordni.com

ACCORD Derry Couples Counselling Our counselling specialists provide in-person and online services to individuals and couples dealing with relationship challenges. Please contact (028) 71362475 or derry@accordni.com or visit www.accordni.com

Strabane Community Project Community Garden Excitingly, the triple award-winning 'Trussell's Together Garden' from RHS Chelsea Flower Show, and the first RHS Chelsea garden ever to be relocated to N Ireland, will be making its permanent home at Strabane Community Project. While the garden was originally due to open this autumn, Trussell Trust & Rob Hardy Garden Design have taken the decision to move the public opening to May 2027. This will allow time to enhance and complete the wider community garden capital works by Strabane Community Project, ensuring the Together Garden sits within a vibrant, welcoming and fully realised space from day one, allowing local people to benefit from a complete community asset that can support connection, wellbeing and community activity for years to come. We look forward to seeing you when it opens in May 2027.

The Annual Triduum of Masses for the feast of St Therese of Lisieux takes place at Termonbacca, Derry from Tuesday 29th September – Thursday 1st October at 7:30 pm each evening. On Tuesday there will be healing prayers for all those who are sick, on Wednesday a special blessing of children and Thursday we will have the blessing of roses. All welcome to come along and join us.

Adult Safeguarding Training for Strabane (Camus)/Leckpatrick/Lifford (Clonleigh)

We have invited Mrs Briega O'Neill, Safeguarding Co-ordinator for the Diocese of Derry to facilitate Adult Safeguarding Training. Adult Safeguarding Training is relevant to clergy, sacristans, church secretaries, parish housekeepers, parish caretakers, pastoral or parish council members, adult prayer group leaders and members, SPRED group leaders, senior choir leaders, Legion of Mary volunteers, members of St Vincent de Paul groups, and Eucharistic Ministers to those people confined to their homes or visiting nursing homes / care homes and all those in the parish who are interested in safeguarding adults at risk and in need of protection. **Training will take place on Saturday 3rd October at 10.00 am Mass in Church of the Immaculate Conception followed by training in St Patrick's Hall from 10.30 am –**

1.00 pm followed by a light lunch. Please confirm your attendance by 1.00 pm on Thursday 1st October by contacting the pastoral office: tel 028 7188 2215 / email strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org

Serving as a Priest Are you 18+ and thinking or wondering about serving the Church as a priest of the Derry Diocese? There will be an afternoon talk with time for prayer, discussion, questions & answers in Derry on Sunday 11th October. For further details please contact Fr Pat O'Hagan at pgoh2111@gmail.com

The Novena to Our Lady, Untier of Knots Novena begins after 7.30 pm Mass on Thursday 1st Oct in St Eugene's Cathedral and continues each Thursday until 26th November. Do you have "knots" in your life? Knots of discord in your family, unresolved pain in relationships, or a lack of peace and joy in your home? Sometimes life can feel like one overwhelming knot, especially when we face health challenges or burdens beyond our control. This novena reminds us that sin never entangled Our Lady, and that Christ gave us His Mother as Our Lady, Untier of Knots. Through this devotion, we entrust our personal "knots" to her loving care – learning to let go and allowing her to gently untie what binds us. All are welcome to join in prayer and reflection during this special time of grace.

Flu Vaccine Clinic Patients over 65 only are invited for the flu and covid vaccinations at Castlefin Health Centre and Lifford Health Centre on the dates and times outlined below. Please contact the surgery to book your appointment.

Castlefin Health Centre – 074 9146694

Wednesday 30th September: 11.00 am – 12 noon

Thursday 1st October: 11.00 am -12 noon

Friday 2nd October: 11.00 am - 12 noon

Lifford Health Centre – 074 9141024

Monday 28th September: 11.00 am – 12 noon & 4.00 pm – 5.00 pm

Tuesday 29th September : 11.00 am – 12 noon & 4.00 pm – 5.00 pm

Wednesday 30th September: 11.00 am – 12 noon & 4.00 pm – 5.00pm

Thursday 1st October: 11.00 am – 12 noon & 4.00 pm – 5.00pm

Friday 2nd October: 11.00 am – 12 noon & 4.00 pm – 5.00 pm

Alternatively, there will be walk-in availability Monday – Friday in Lifford Health Centre during our normal opening hours. Just present to reception on arrival.

Children's Nasal Flu Vaccine from age 2 years – 17 years 11 months is also available.

Parish Bingo & Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Patrick's Hall every Thursday at 8 pm for bingo and lucky four. Come along for some fun and excitement.

Catholic Mothers Ireland Ulster Retreat Day on Saturday 3rd October from 10 am – 6 pm at Benburb Priory. A day of prayer, reflection, and spiritual renewal. Speakers: Fr Barry Matthews, Fr Gerry Campbell, Helen Stewart and Jim Deeds. Lunch/refreshments provided. Cost: £45. Booking: www.catholicmothers.ie/retreats

Season of Creation Every community, prayer, and action for our common home is a drop of hope. From Italy to Chile, Bogota, Glasgow, Bengaluru and Winnipeg, Living Water is flowing, in celebrations, learning experiences with young people, daily commitments and concrete actions to care for creation. Visit <https://laudatosimovement.org/.../living-water-stories.../>

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: 4.30 pm; Sunday: 11.00 am

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: 12.15 pm

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Sat Vigil: 6.30 pm (6.00 pm from 3/10/26); Sunday: 9.45 am

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (27th Sept – alternate Sundays – 11th Oct)

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (4th Oct – alternate Sundays – 18th Oct)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes. **Office hours:** Monday – Thursday 9.30 am – 4.30 pm; Friday 9.30 am – 12.30 pm.

Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church, please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org

To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities in **Northern Ireland**, please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services: 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services: 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service: 028 95049999.

To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities in **Republic of Ireland**, please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana: 074 9320540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny: 074 9167100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 074 9102233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding Donegal: 071 9834660.